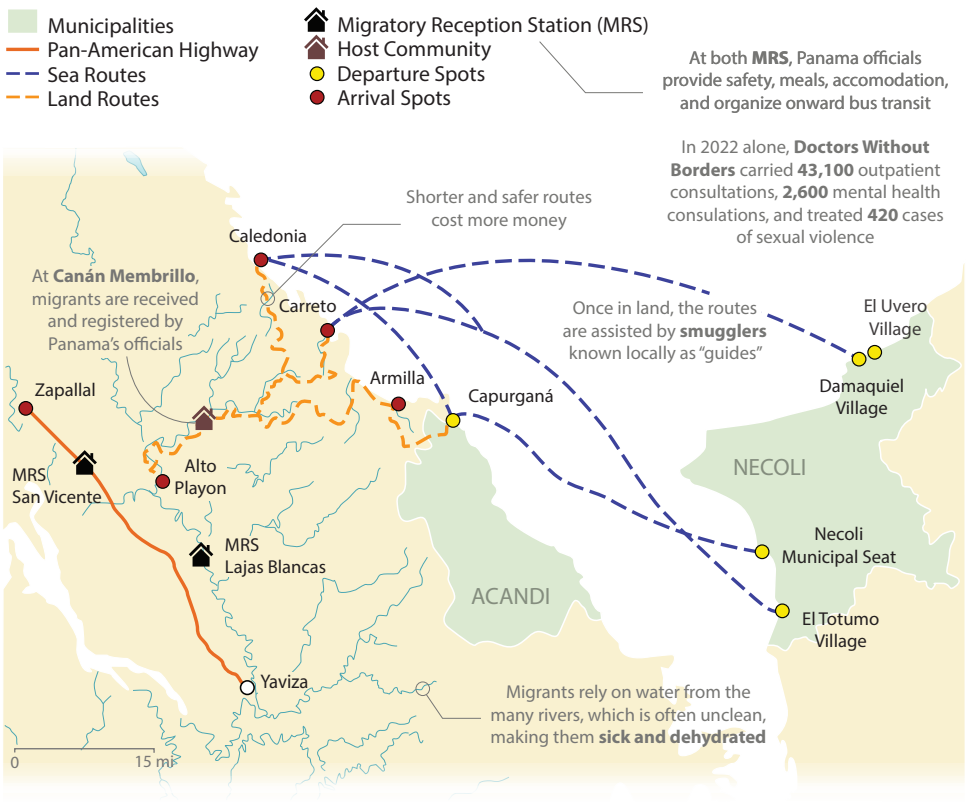
Defying death

This year, over 400,000 migrants and asylum seekers have traversed the challenging expanse of the Central American jungle known as the Darién Gap, as reported by the government of Panama. Despite the formidable dangers and obstacles within the jungle, it stands as the sole terrestrial route linking South America to Central America. Those undertaking this journey face numerous human rights violations, including sexual violence, homicides, disappearances, trafficking, robbery, and intimidation perpetrated by organized criminal groups.



Major routes taken to cross the Darién Gap

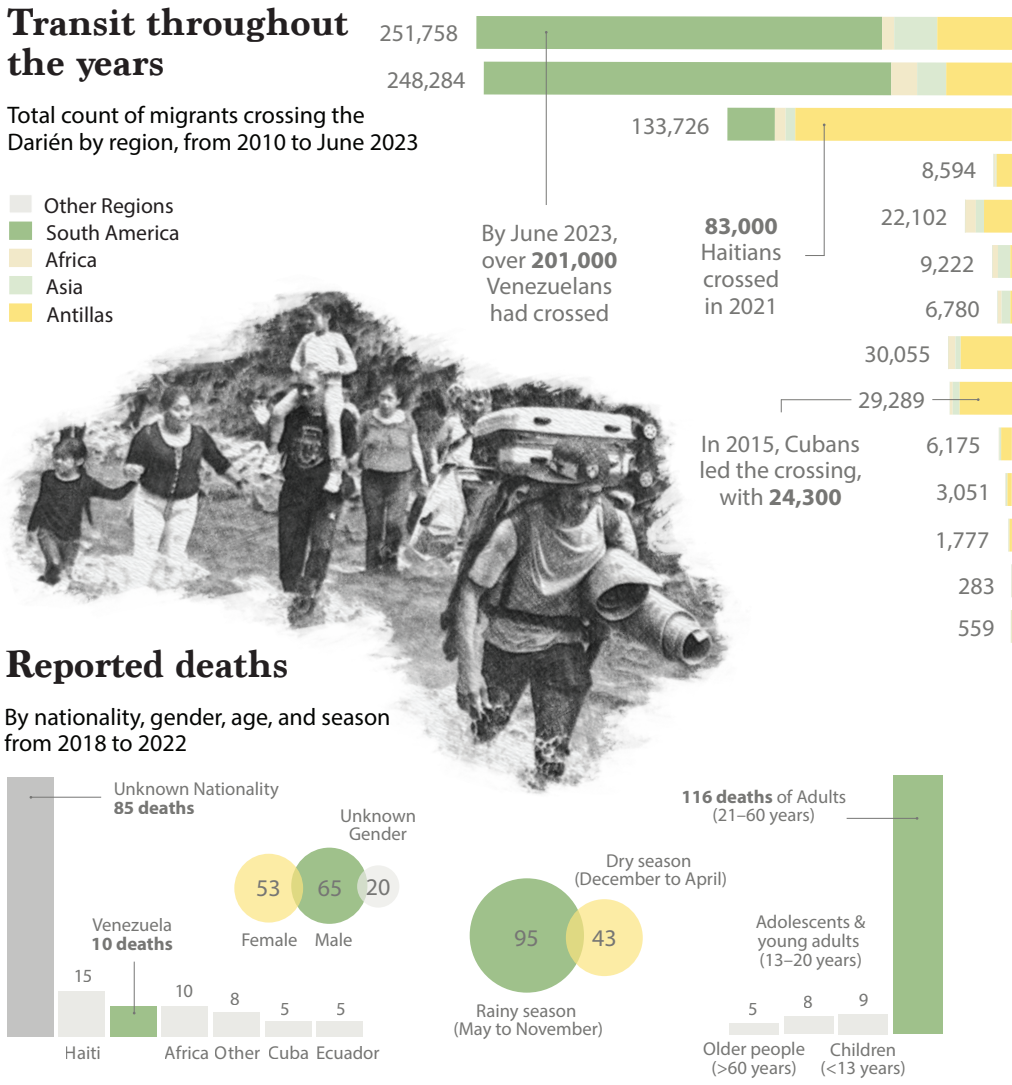
A detailed map of the most frequented routes in 2023. Each route varies in difficulty, dangers, and costs. Depending on weather conditions, the journey to reach an MRS can take several days to weeks



Sources: GIFMM/R4V; IOM UN Migration; Médecins Sans Frontières

Transit throughout the years

Total count of migrants crossing the Darién by region, from 2010 to June 2023



Reported deaths

By nationality, gender, age, and season from 2018 to 2022

Venezuela's migration rates lead the Darién

Total count of people migrating through the Darién Gap from 2010 to June 2023. The top five nationalities that cross the Darién Gap over the years have been selected to highlight Venezuela's migration boom



Migration rates

Migrant(s) per 1,000 people as of October 2023

Country	Migration Rate
Venezuela	13.55
India	0.12
Ecuador	0
China	-0.11
Haiti	-1.86
Cuba	-2.53

Sources: National Migration Service of Panama
Graphics by: Daniela A. Gonzalez

Main death causes

Official count from 2018 to 2022. These numbers represent only a fraction of the real casualties, as deaths are not officially reported to the authorities

